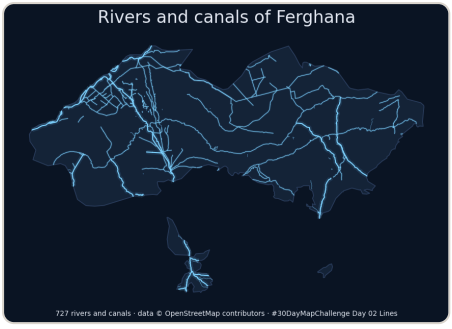
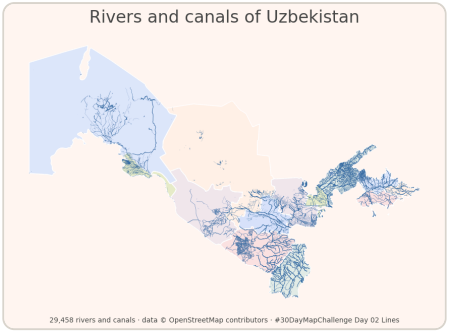
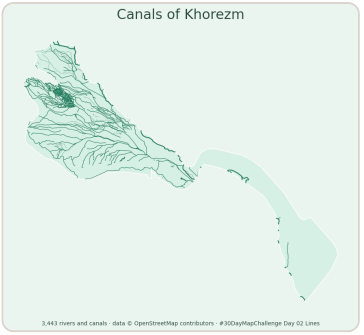
〰️ Day 02 · Lines: rivers, roads and railways inside your region

A beginner tutorial with Python in Google Colab. No installation, no experience needed.

You will draw the regions of Uzbekistan, turn their edges into **boundary lines**, and fill your favourite region with thousands of **rivers and canals** (or roads, or railways) from OpenStreetMap. In the end you choose the region, the lines and the colours, so everyone's map comes out different.

⏱️ About 20 minutes · 💻 Any computer with a browser · 🔑 A Google account (Gmail)

Ferghana, `night`	**Uzbekistan, `pastel`**	**Khorezm, `mint`**
		

📚 Part 0 · Two ideas you need

Boundaries. A boundary file stores the outline of each region. In this tutorial we use the **14 regions** of Uzbekistan (12 regions, Karakalpakstan and Tashkent City).

Lines. On a map, a *line* is a list of points joined together: a river, a canal, a road or a railway. Even a region's border is a line!

Clipping joins the two ideas. The region is the cookie cutter and the lines are the dough. We keep only the lines **inside** the region.

Our data comes from OpenStreetMap, the free world map made by volunteers. It's already prepared for you in the `data` folder:

File	What's inside
`uzbekistan_regions.geojson`	the 14 regions
`waterways.geojson`	~34,000 rivers, canals, drains and mountain streams
`railways.geojson`	~13,000 railway lines
`roads.geojson`	~23,000 main roads

🚀 Part 1 · Launch the tutorial

Google Colab lets you run Python code in your browser for free. A *notebook* is a page that mixes text and code. You don't need to install anything.

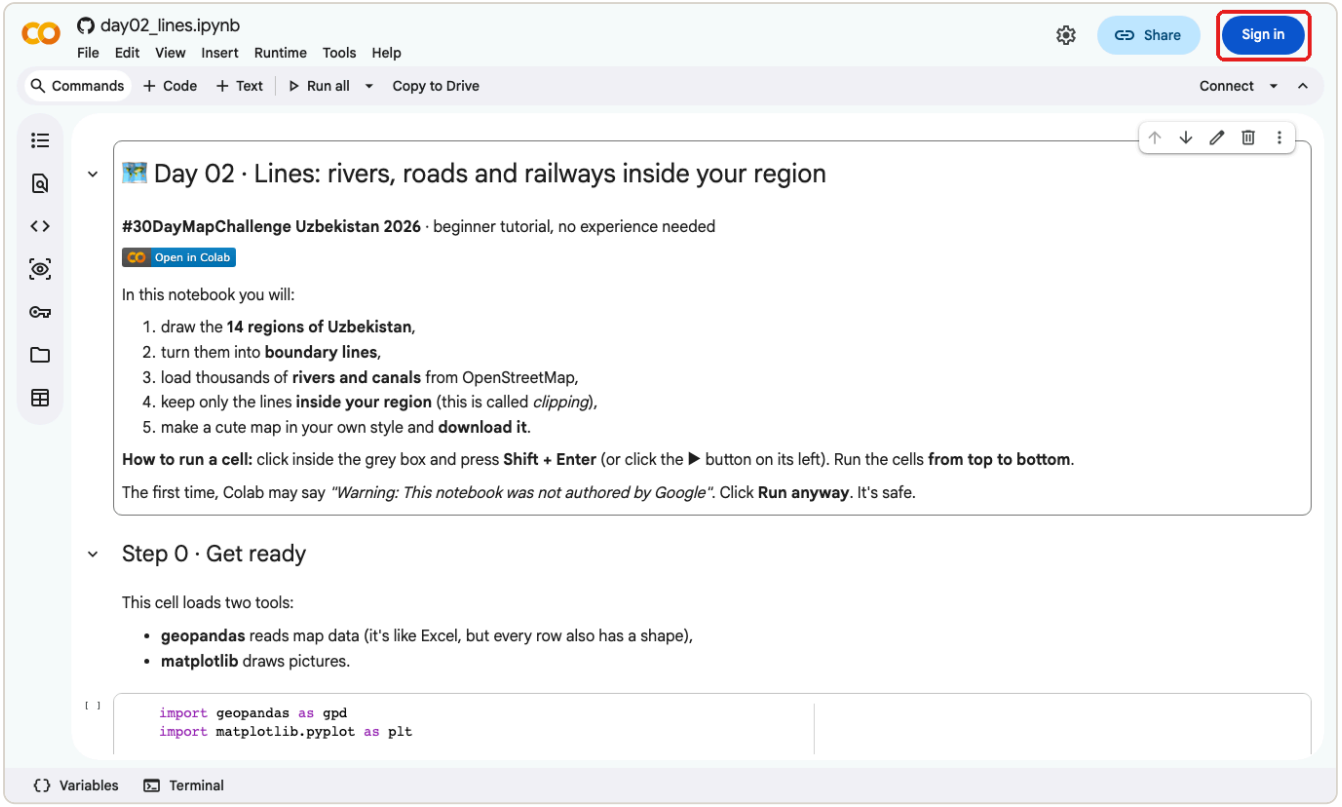
Option A · One click (recommended)

1. Click this button:

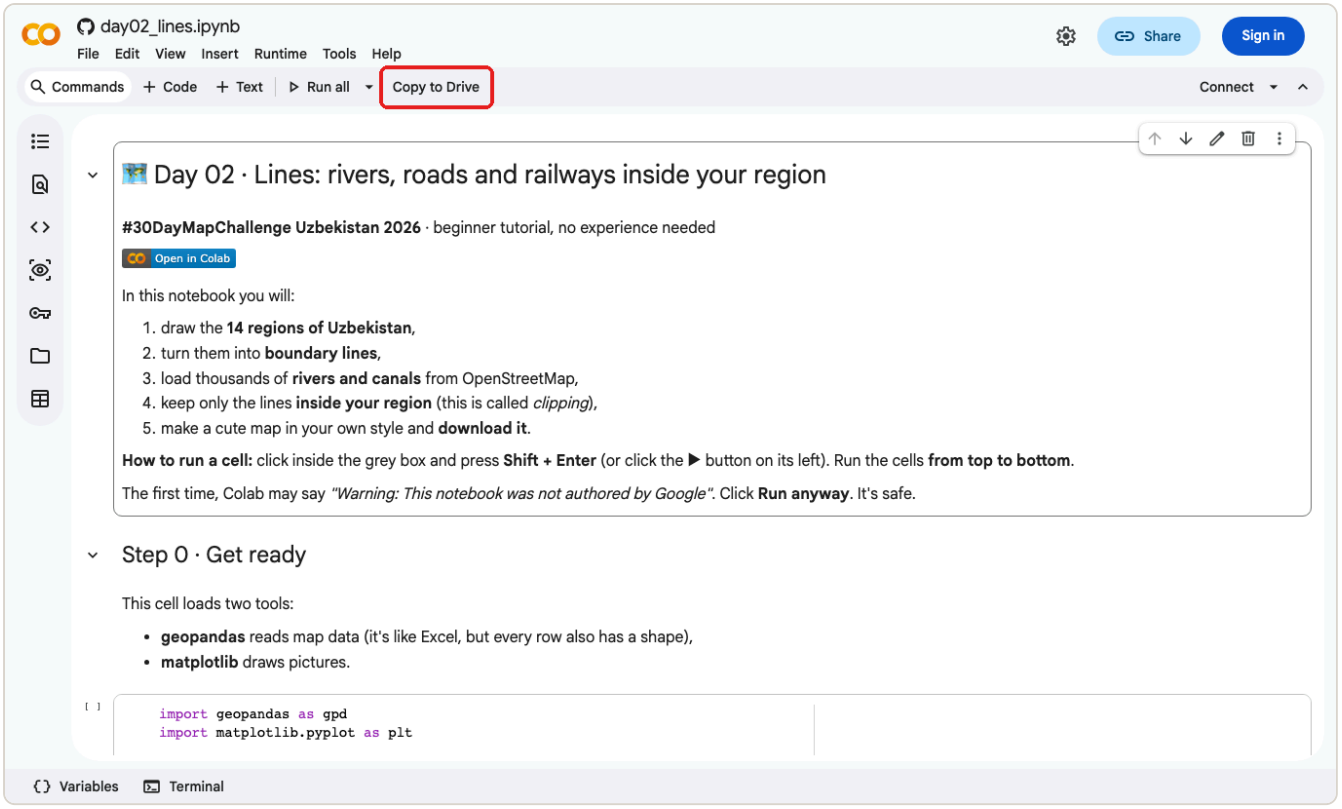
   Open in Colab

   (or copy this address into your browser: `colab.research.google.com/github/NodiraTillayeva/30DayMapChallengeUzbekistan/blob/main/2026/Day%2002%20Lines/tutorial/day02_lines.ipynb`)

2. The notebook opens. Click **Sign in** (top right) and log in with your Google account. You need to sign in to run code.



3. **Keep your own copy (recommended).** Click **Copy to Drive** in the toolbar. Colab opens your personal copy, saved in your Google Drive in the folder *Colab Notebooks*. Work in that copy: your changes are saved and you can come back to it later. Without a copy, your changes disappear when you close the tab.



Option B · Open it from Colab yourself

1. Go to colab.research.google.com and sign in.
2. In the window that opens, choose the **GitHub** tab (or **File → Open notebook → GitHub**).
3. Paste `NodiraTillayeva/30DayMapChallengeUzbekistan`, press Enter, and click `2026/Day 02 Lines/tutorial/day02_lines.ipynb`.

Option C · On your own computer (for people who already use Python)

1. Download the notebook: open `day02_lines.ipynb` on GitHub and click the **Download raw file** button (⬇, top right of the file).
2. Open it in Jupyter, JupyterLab or VS Code. You need the packages `geopandas` and `matplotlib` (`pip install geopandas matplotlib`).
3. It reads the data from the internet, like in Colab. To work offline, download the data (Part 2) and change `BASE` in the first cell to your data folder, e.g. `BASE = "data/"`.

📥 Part 2 · Get the datasets

In Colab you don't need to download anything. The notebook reads all the data from this project on GitHub by itself (that's what the `BASE = "https://..."` line in Step 0 does).

Download the data only if you want to use it in another program, such as **QGIS**, **kepler.gl** or **ArcGIS**, or to work offline.

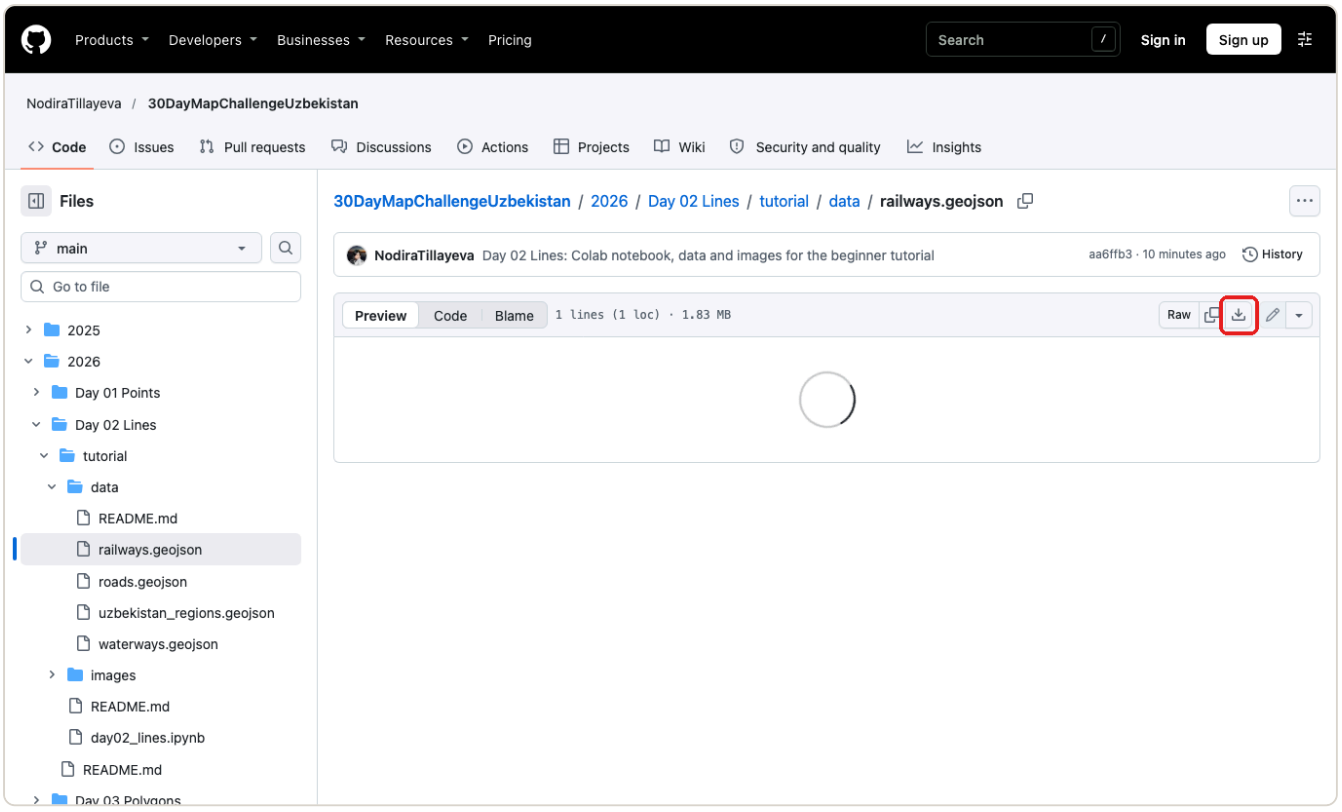
All files at once

⬇️ **Download day02_lines_data.zip** (2.2 MB). It contains the four files below and a `README.md`. Unzip it (right-click → *Extract all* on Windows, double-click on Mac).

One file at a time

File	What's inside	Size
`uzbekistan_regions.geojson`	the 14 regions (column `region`)	0.1 MB
`waterways.geojson`	33,793 rivers, canals, drains and streams (column `kind`)	8.0 MB
`railways.geojson`	13,091 railway lines	1.9 MB
`roads.geojson`	23,232 main roads: `motorway`, `trunk`, `primary`, `secondary`	3.6 MB

Click a file name, then click the **Download raw file** button (⬇) at the top right of the page:



How to open the files

- **QGIS:** drag the `.geojson` file into the QGIS window, or use *Layer → Add Layer → Add Vector Layer*.
- **kepler.gl:** open kepler.gl/demo and drag the file in (like in the Day 01 tutorial).
- **Python:** `gpd.read_file("waterways.geojson")`.
- **geojson.io:** for a quick look at the small regions file, drag it into geojson.io.

The original, full-size data

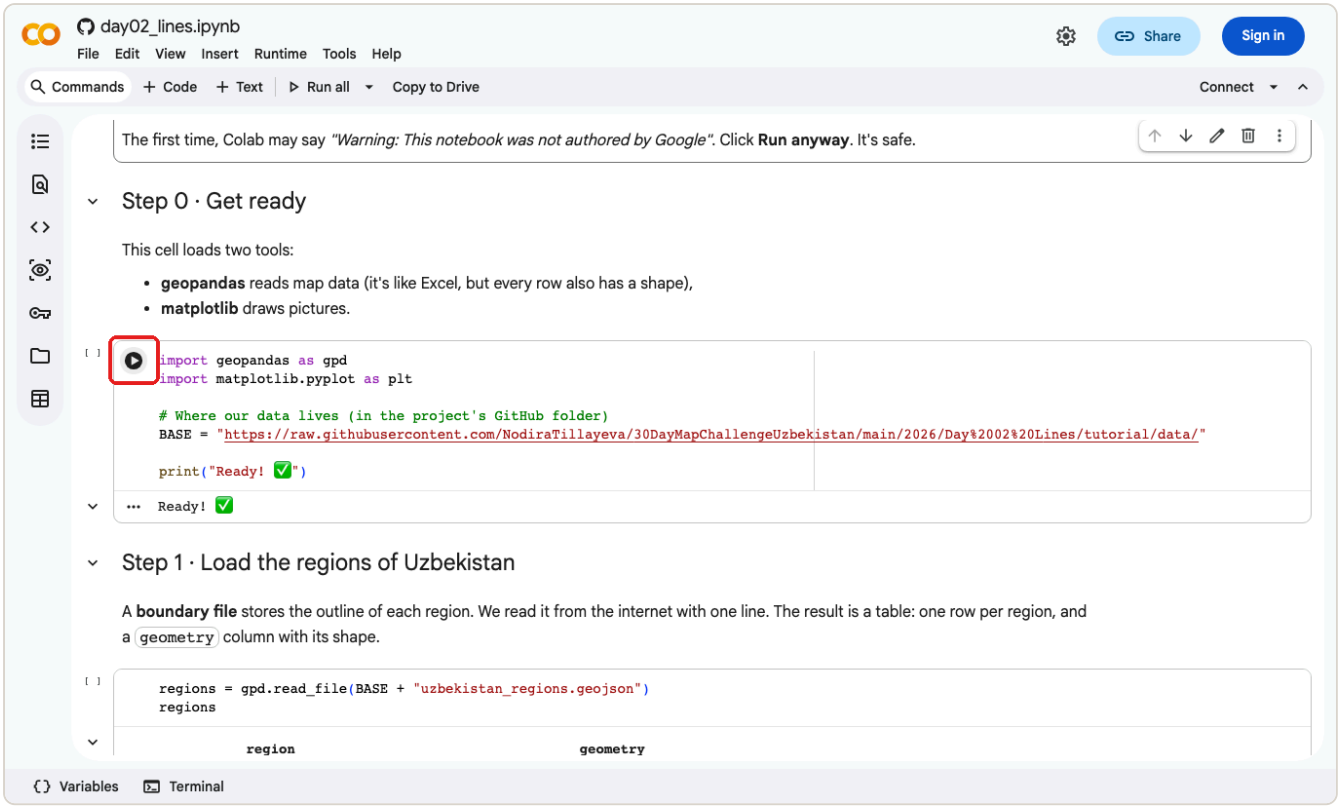
Our files are simplified copies. The originals are free:

- **OpenStreetMap for Uzbekistan:** download.geofabrik.de/asia/uzbekistan.html → *uzbekistan-latest-free.shp.zip* (about 270 MB). Use the layers `gis_osm_waterways_free_1`, `gis_osm_railways_free_1` and `gis_osm_roads_free_1`.
- **Region boundaries:** `2025/Boundaries/uz.shp` in this repository (from simplemaps.com).

▶️ Part 3 · How to run a cell

The notebook is made of **cells**. Text cells explain things. Grey boxes are **code cells**.

To run a code cell, click the ▶ **button** on its left (it appears when you move the mouse over the cell), or click inside the cell and press **Shift + Enter**.



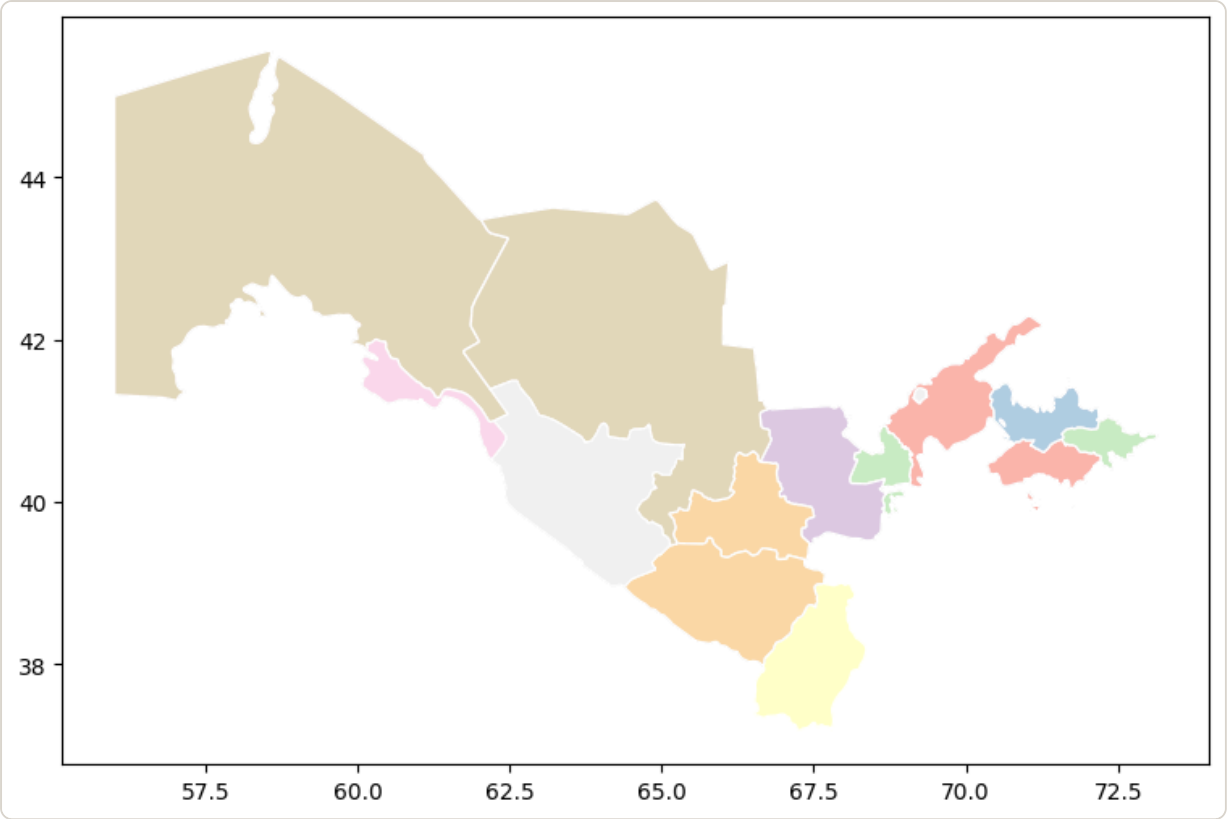
The first time, Colab shows **"Warning: This notebook was not authored by Google"**. Click **Run anyway**. That's normal for notebooks from GitHub.

Run the first cell (Step 0). When you see `Ready! ✅` under it, you're set.

> 💡 Always run the cells **in order, from top to bottom**. Each cell uses what the cells above it created.

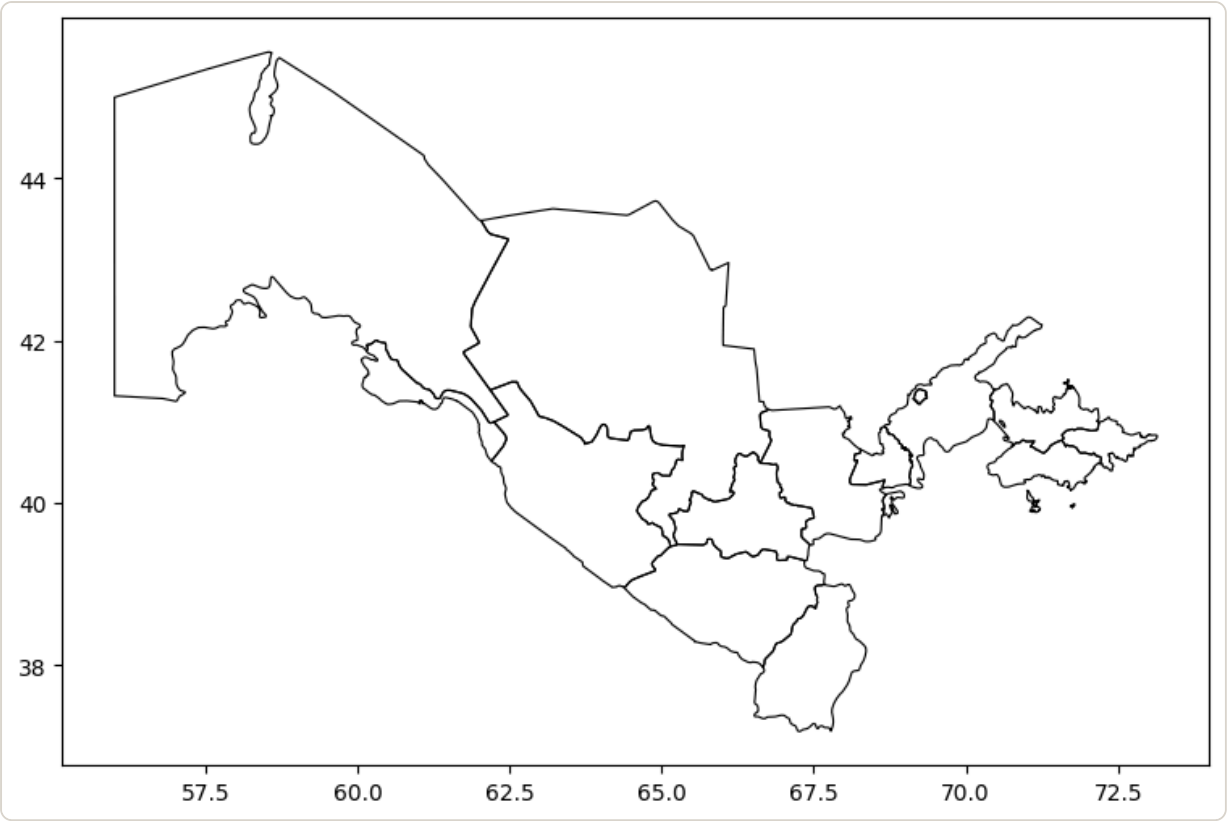
🗺️ Part 4 · Draw the regions (Step 1)

Run the two cells of **Step 1**. The first one reads the boundary file and shows it as a table with 14 rows. The second one draws it:



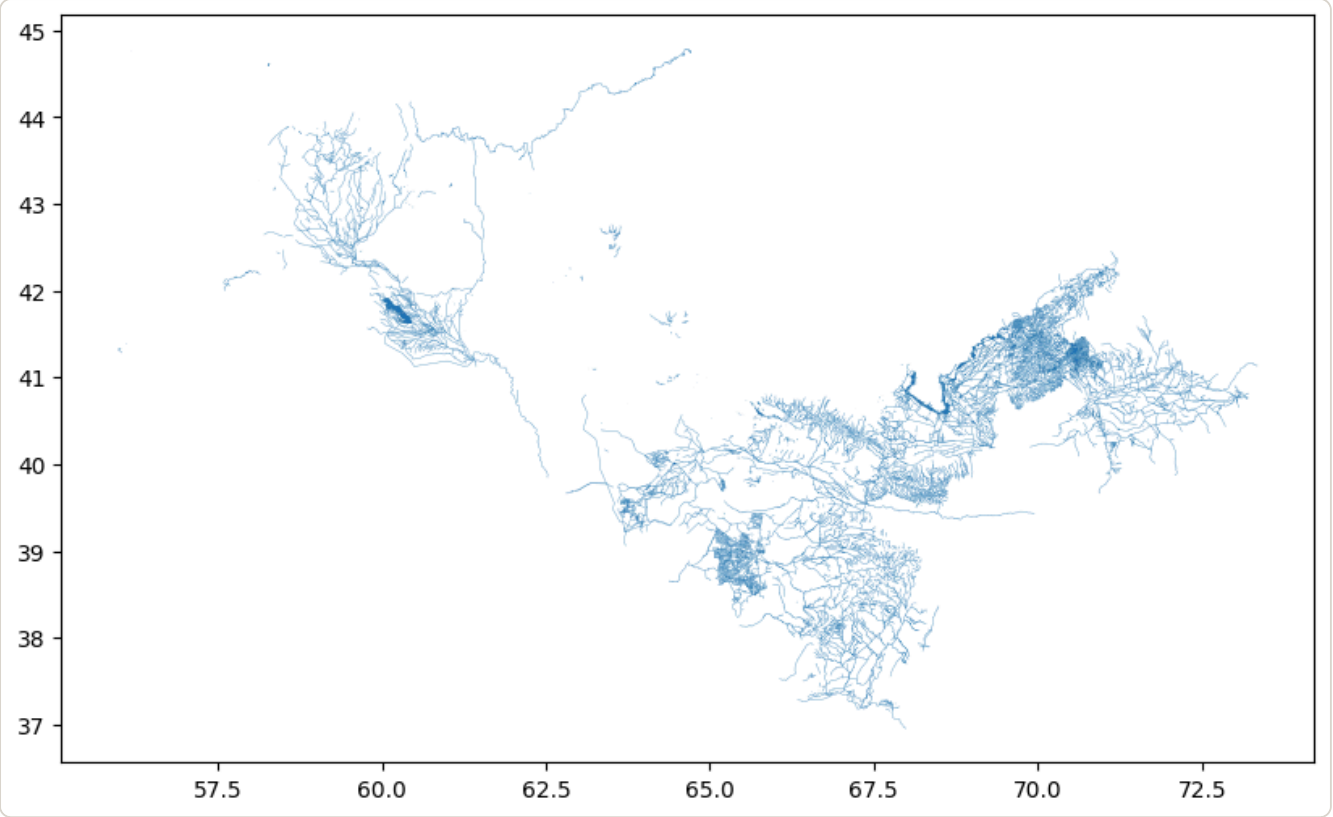
〰 Part 5 · Turn the regions into lines (Step 2)

Run **Step 2**. `.boundary` keeps only the edges of each region, so the filled shapes become **lines**:



💧 Part 6 · Load the rivers and canals (Step 3)

Run the two cells of **Step 3**. The first one tells you how many lines there are of each kind. The second draws them all:



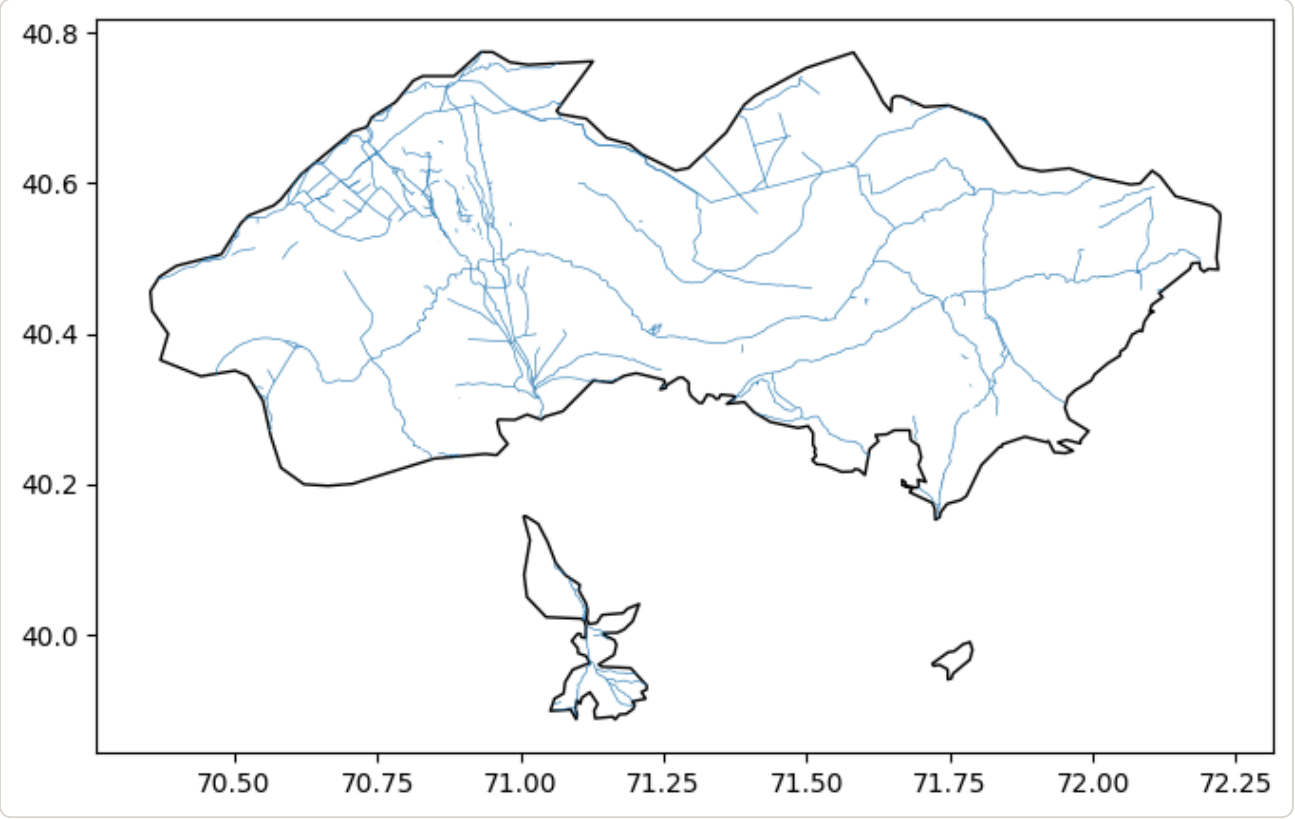
Look how many canals there are, especially in the Ferghana Valley, Khorezm and Bukhara! Most of Uzbekistan's water flows through irrigation canals.

✂️ Part 7 · Keep only the lines inside your region (Step 4)

This is the main skill of today: **clipping**.

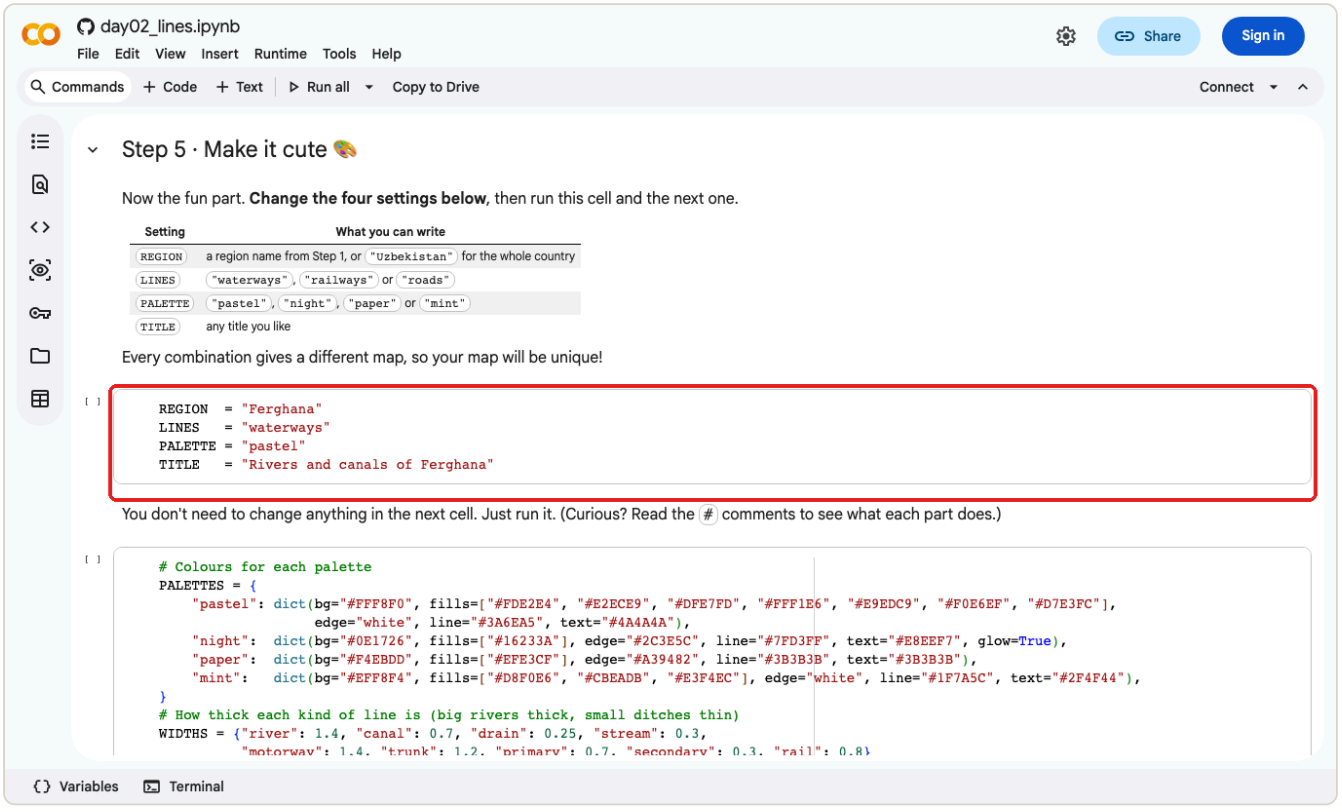
In the Step 4 cell, change `MY_REGION = "Ferghana"` to your region and run it. Region names must be written **exactly** like this:

`Andijon` · `Bukhoro` · `Ferghana` · `Jizzakh` · `Karakalpakstan` · `Kashkadarya` · `Khorezm` · `Namangan` · `Navoi` · `Samarkand` · `Sirdaryo` · `Surkhandarya` · `Tashkent City` · `Tashkent Region`



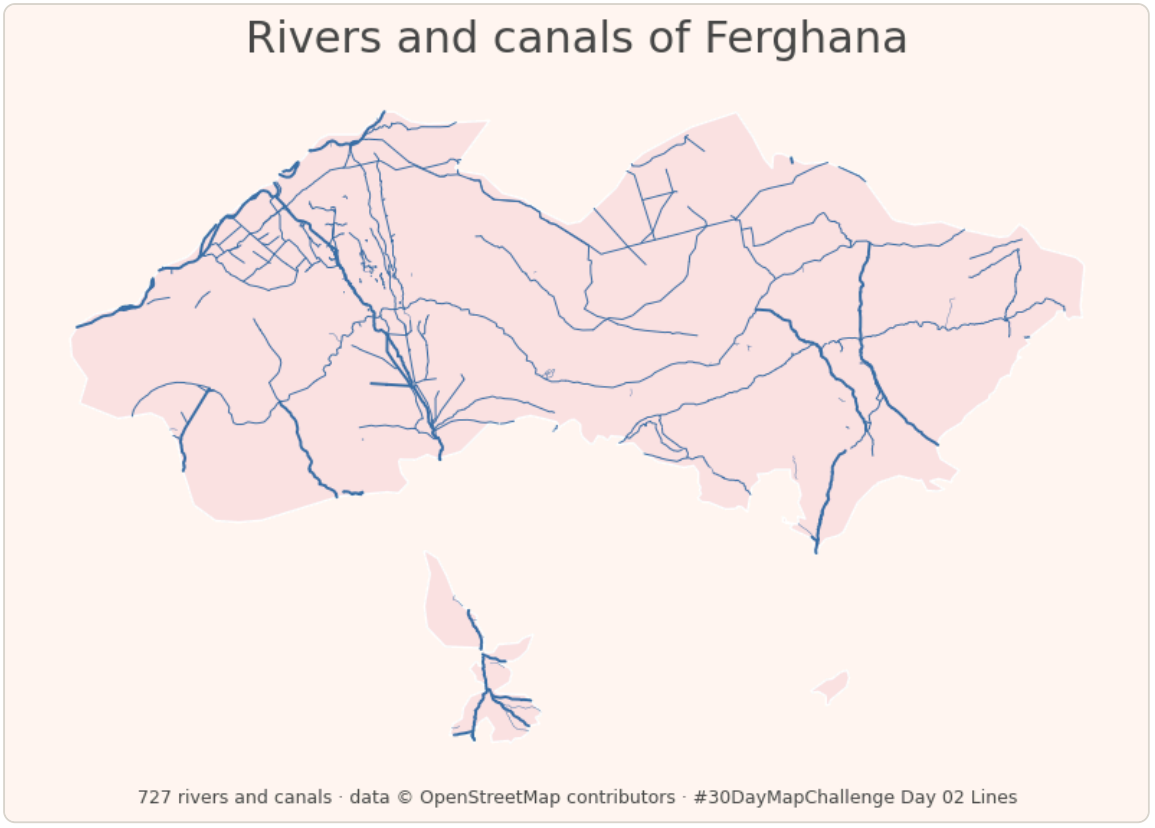
🎨 Part 8 · Make it cute (Step 5)

Now find the **settings cell** in Step 5 and change the four settings:



Setting	What you can write
`REGION`	a region name from the list above, or `"Uzbekistan"` for the whole country
`LINES`	`"waterways"`, `"railways"` or `"roads"`
`PALETTE`	`"pastel"`, `"night"`, `"paper"` or `"mint"`
`TITLE`	any title you like, inside quotes

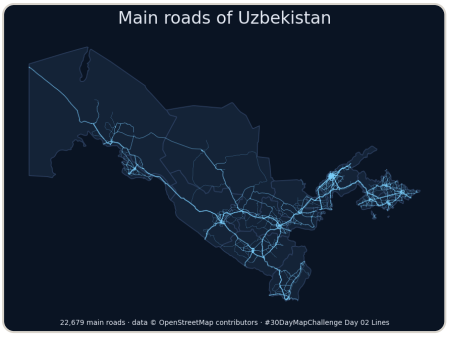
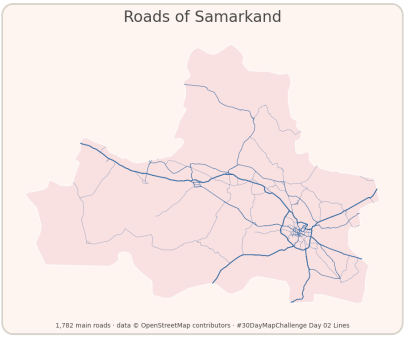
Then run the settings cell **and** the big cell under it. Your map appears:



Rivers are drawn thick, canals medium, and small ditches thin, so the big rivers stand out. For large areas the lines automatically get thinner so they don't blur together.

🌈 Make it yours: ideas

Change the settings and run the two cells again. Some combinations to try:

`"Uzbekistan", "roads", "night"`	`"Samarkand", "roads", "pastel"`	`"Tashkent Region", "railways", "paper"`
		

Challenges for the curious:

- Show only the big rivers: in Step 5, after the line `inside = gpd.clip(data, area)`, add `inside = inside[inside["kind"] == "river"]`.
- Change a colour: in `PALETTES`, replace a colour code like `"#3A6EA5"` with any colour from htmlcolorcodes.com.
- Compare two regions: make one map for a river region (Khorezm) and one for a mountain region (Surkhandarya).

💾 Part 9 · Save and share your map

1. Run the cell in **Step 6**. Your map downloads as `my_day02_map.png` (check your *Downloads* folder).
2. Make a folder named after **your map's topic**, e.g. `Canals of Khorezm`. Put your map inside, plus a short `README.md` with **your name**, the data (OpenStreetMap) and the tool (Python in Colab).
3. Upload the folder to `2026/Day 02 Lines/` in this repository. The Quick Start in the main README shows how, with no coding needed.
4. Post it with **#30DayMapChallenge** and credit **© OpenStreetMap contributors**.

🆘 Something went wrong?

What you see	What to do
`NameError: name 'gpd' is not defined` (or `'regions'`, `'lines'`)	You skipped a cell. Run all the cells from the top again, in order. Or click **Runtime** → **Run all**.
`AssertionError: Check the spelling of REGION!` (or `MY_REGION`)	The region name has a typo. Copy it exactly from the list in Part 7, including capital letters and quotes.
`AssertionError: LINES must be ...` or `PALETTE must be ...`	Use one of the values from the table in Part 8, e.g. `"night"`, not `"blue"`.
`SyntaxError`	A quote `"` is missing. Every text value needs quotes on both sides: `"Samarkand"`.
The download doesn't start	Allow pop-ups for Colab, or click the 📁 **Files** icon on the left, find `my_day02_map.png`, click ⋮ → **Download**.
It asks me to sign in	Click **Sign in** (top right). Colab needs a Google account to run code.
Everything is broken	Click **Runtime** → **Restart session**, then **Runtime** → **Run all**.

📎 Credits

- Lines: © OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL), downloaded from Geofabrik on 2 November 2026 and simplified. See `data/README.md`.
- Region boundaries: simplemaps.com, from `2025/Boundaries` in this repository.
- Tools: Google Colab, GeoPandas, Matplotlib.